

Usability Testing: Astro Hotel Pasadena

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Research Plan

Stakeholder: Astro Hotel Pasadena

Recommendations/Issues

- Make the booking experience fast and easy
- Create an experience that puts the needs of the customer first

Interviews

I conducted 5 in-person usability tests, testing both the desktop and mobile versions of the website. Each session was done in the user's home and each user was given 6 tasks to test the usability of the Astro Hotel website. The first group of tasks tested the website's navigation, while the second group of tasks tested the booking process.

Alex, Interview 1

- Unable to navigate back to the home page from booking screen
- Unable to modify booking details
- Unable to find Yelp review button on homepage

Michael, Interview 2

- Confused on why he couldn't add more children to the room
- Wasn't able to view prices from the amenities page

Paulette, Interview 3

- Prefers human contact over chat support
- Books hotels frequently and expected a similar booking experience

Alex, Interview 4

- Confused about pictures of rooms on gallery page
- Did not realize page had loaded

Efrain, Interview 5

- Didn't find 'Nearby Attractions' page very useful – lack of links

Research Metadata

Background

Every year, thousands of visitors come to Pasadena for the Rose Parade and the Rose Bowl football game. I saw this as an opportunity to help a local Pasadena business better serve their customers by improving their website's usability.

Goals

- Uncover usability issues and improve the website experience for both web and mobile users
- Present actionable insights to create a better booking experience
- Create an experience that will make customers want to come back

Methodologies

- Scripted in-person usability sessions
- Cardsorting

Script

10 min ▾

Introduction

Welcome

→ 3 min

Welcome participants and break the ice to make them comfortable. Introduce yourself and explain the purpose of the study. We are designing a website and we want to make sure it works as intended. Our session is probably going to take 30 minutes.

Overview

→ 5 min

I want to emphasize that we are testing the website, not you. There is nothing you can say or do that is wrong; we aren't looking for right or wrong answers because there aren't any. I just want your honest feedback because that is what will help us improve the website.

Process

→ 2 min

Explain the process. A task-oriented study. Introduce think-aloud method and task scenario handout. Go over ground rules – I may interrupt if the conversation steers off course; I may remind you to think aloud; I cannot help you once the study starts – pretend you are alone. Ask for permission to record.

10 min ▾

Establishing Context

Before we begin, what is your occupation? What do you do for work?

Add notes

If you had to guess, how many hours a week do you think you use the internet (at home and at work, including browsing and email)?

Notes:

When you're browsing, what kind of websites are you typically visiting?

Notes:

Do you have any favorite sites?

Notes:

What do you typically use the internet for?

Notes:

15 min ▾

Homepage Tasks

Before we go into any tasks, can you please look at the homepage and tell me what you make of it: what strikes you about it? What are your first impressions?

- Feel free to scroll around if you want to, but please don't click on anything yet
- Whose site do you think this belongs too? What can you do here? What would you use the site for? Why would someone book this hotel?

Notes:

[Thank you. Now I'm going to ask you to try doing some specific tasks. I'm going to read each one out loud and give you a printed copy. And again, as much as possible, it will help us if you can try to think out loud as you go along.]

Scenario 1

You are planning a vacation with your family for January of next year. You want to stay in Pasadena because you plan on going to the Rose Parade. Before choosing this

hotel, you decide to contact the hotel to ask about any specific deals they might have for January 2027.

Scenario 1 – Task

Please show me how you would reach out to the hotel.

[Please think aloud as you go through the website.]

Notes:

Scenario 2

Before staying at this hotel, you want to find out what other people have said about staying here.

Scenario 2 – Task

Please show me how you would find reviews that other guests have left.

Notes:

Scenario 3

You are curious about their rooms. You want to find out what the rooms look like, what amenities they have, and what bed options they offer.

Scenario 3 – Task

Please show me how you would do this.

Notes:

Scenario 4

In preparation for your visit to Pasadena, you are curious about the hotel's location and want to find out

what's near the hotel, how far it is from the Rose Parade, and what is there to do in the area.

Scenario 4 – Task

Please show me how you would do this.

Notes:

10 min ▾

Booking Tasks

Scenario 5

You decide to stay at this hotel. You want to book a room from December 31, 2026 to January 7, 2027. You want 1 room for 2 adults with one Queen bed.

Scenario 5 – Task

Please show me how you would book this room.

Notes:

Scenario 6

Imagine that you invite a friend and their partner with 2 kids to join you, and they say yes. So now, you want to book 2 rooms. One room for 2 adults with one Queen bed – this is for you. And one room for 2 adults and 2 kids with two Queen beds – for your friend, their partner, and their 2 kids.

Scenario 6 – Task

Please show me how you would book these rooms.

Notes:

5 min ▾

Conclusion

Duration

→ 3 min

Final question: Why would someone book this hotel?

Duration

→ 2 min

Thank you for your time. Do you have any questions, final comments or closing remarks?